UTN
Facultad Regional Córdoba

TUP

Tecnicatura Universitaria en Programación

INGLÉS I

Unidad Temática N° 1:
Frase Nominal

Actividad Complementaria III
1° Año – 2° Cuatrimestre

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Compounds

A - Compound nouns

Compound nouns consist of two or more words used together as a single word, e.g. *hard drive*. In a compound there is a headword and one or more modifiers.

ink-jet modifier	*printer* head

Modifiers can refer to different things:

- material, e.g. **silicon chip** = a chip made of silicon
- use or function, e.g. **search engine** = a program used to find information on the Web
- activity or profession, e.g. **software engineer =** a person who designs software
- place, e.g. **web portal** = a site on the Web that acts as a gateway to other sites

Compound nouns are written in different ways:

- as two separate words, e.g. **control panel** = a utility that lets you configure and adjust a system
- as two words joined with a hyphen, e.g. **self-test** = an automatic examination of a device
- as one word, e.g., **clipboard** = a holding place for text or graphics you've just cut or copied

Unfortunately there are no rules. For example, you may see *clip art*, *clip-art* and *clipart.*

Some compounds change over time, for example two words – *web site* – become hyphenated after a time, and then eventually end up as one word – *website*.

The two parts may be:

1. noun + noun: **address bus** = set of wires that identifies locations, addresses, in the main memory.

bandwidth = the rate at which data flows through a cable or network.

mail merge = a tool that combines a standard letter with a mailing list to create personalized letters.

2. adjective + noun: **broadband** = high-speed connection, e.g. cable or ADSL Internet access.

shortcut = a small file, 1KB in size, that links to a real file stored elsewhere.

smart card = a plastic card that contains a small chip.

3. verb or verbal noun + noun: **scrollbar** = part of a window that lets you move through a document.

recording head = a mechanism that transfers data to a disk.

4. verb + particle: **add-on** = a hardware or software module that can be added to a computer.

set-up / **setup** = the way in which a program or device is configured.

Compound nouns normally have the main stress on the first part and a secondary stress on the second part, e.g. screen saver /'skri:n serva(r)/.

B - Compound adjectives

Compound adjectives are made up of two words, normally with hyphens between them. The second part is often a past participle:

A **menu-driven** program lets you select a command from a menu.

A **voice-activated** product is activated by the user's voice.

Object-oriented programming is based on objects and their effects on each other, rather than on a series of instructions.

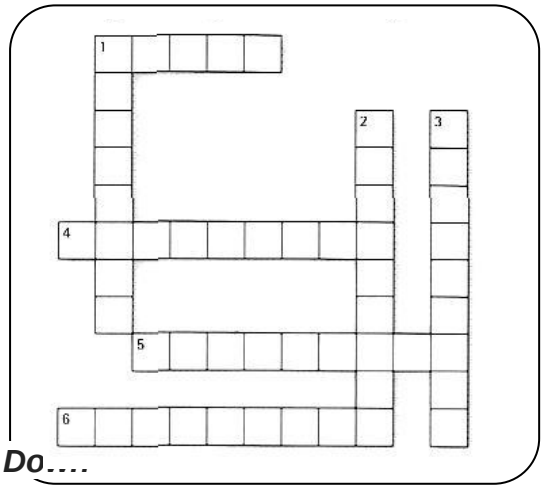
Other common patterns include:

- ***noun + present participle:***
  Space-saving PCs take up very little desktop space.
- ***noun + adjective:***
  A **hands-free** device does not require the hands for operation.
  A **stand-alone** computer or business can operate on its own.

1. **Look at section A above. Which compound do these definitions refer to?**
    1. a small piece of silicon which is used in computers _____
    2. a site that offers email, news, forums, web searching, online shopping and links to other sites _____
    3. a utility used to adjust computer settings such as fonts, sound and networks _____
    4. the read/write head of a disk drive _____
    5. a computer bus used by the CPU to communicate memory locations _____

2. **Complete these sentences with a compound from section A.**
    1. _____ enables you to combine two files, one containing names and addresses and the other containing a non-specific letter intended for multiple recipients.
    2. A USB headset is a useful _____, the ideal accessory for your computer games and music.
    3. The printer's _____ didn´t identify any errors.
    4. Because the Web has no central organization, every Web surfer needs a _____ - a special site that locates other sites based on words or phrases you type in.
    5. They are seeking a _____ to help write and test a new operating system.

3. **Complete the puzzle with compound nouns.**



Across

1 the configuration of hardware and software

4 a bar that allows you to select the portion of the document you want to see

5 an area that holds the things you copy, ready to be pasted anywhere else

6 a type of data transmission that provides fast Internet access

Do….

1 a special file which redirects to another file or program

2 a small card with an embedded microchip

3 the amount of data that can be transmitted along a channel

4. Complete these sentences with a compound adjective from section B above.

1. A _____ - _____ telephone allows people with limited mobility to dial and answer the phone with just the sound of their voice.
2. A fax machine is a _____ - _____ device, so it does not require any other device to function.
3. A _____ - _____ application is operated by making choices from menus instead of giving instructions on a keyboard.
4. In some countries it is obligatory to use a _____ - _____ car kit when you are using a mobile phone while driving
5. An _____ - _____ language like C++ lets the programmer concentrate on individual units (e.g. a piece of text, a graphic or a table) and give each object functions which can be changed easily.
6. They've launched a new _____ - _____ computer, an entire PC embedded inside a keyboard.

Bibliografía

Marco Fabré, E. & S. Remacha Esteras. (2007). *Professional English in Use ICT* (Intermediate to Advanced). Cambridge, UK. Cambridge University Press.

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